

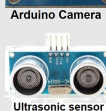
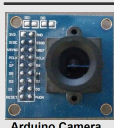
Conferences

- ❖ MICCAI
- ❖ ECML
- ❖ ACCV
- ❖ ICIP

Journals

- ❖ Pattern Recognition
- ❖ IEEE Signal Processing Letters
- ❖ American Journal of Neuroradiology
- ❖ Computerized Medical Imaging and Graphics

Arduino



Arduino Board

QC



Robot



Obstruction



Dual arm robot

Research Statement

Research Area: Industry 4.0, Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Robotics, Computer Vision, Image Processing, Optimization, Bioinformatics, Software Engineering, Computational Cognitive Science, Quality Control and Reliability.

Research Accomplishment: Highlights of my research accomplishments are : (i) I published thirty six (36) peer-reviewed research articles till date (February 2020) in multidisciplinary areas such as Computer Vision and Image Processing, automatizing manufacturing operations by industrial robots using artificial intelligence algorithms, welding sequence optimization, computational cognitive science, theoretical machine learning, optimization and reliability, and natural language processing; (ii) My research articles are published in the reputed journals like Pattern Recognition (Impact Factor (I. F.) 3.453), IEEE Signal Processing Letters (I. F. 2.528), American Journal of Neuroradiology (I. F. 3.550), and premier conferences like MICCAI (Acceptance Rate (A. R.) ~32%, rank 1 conference in computer science) , ECML (A. R. ~30%) , ACCV (A. R. ~29%), and ICIP (A. R. ~45%); (iii) I received 426 google scholar citations and 6755 research gate reads till date; and (iv) I received a very competitive basic science research grant as young investigator and MITACS industrial internship awards for three times during my graduate studies.

Research Contributions: My research interest lies at the intersection of advancement and utilization of algorithms at various applications that can do both. My interest includes : (i) developing computationally viable solutions to large scale (complex) data; (ii) performing completely automated data analysis; (iii) offering solutions to vision based applications that involve multidisciplinary research (Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Computational Intelligence, Computer Vision, Medical Imaging, Bioinformatics, Statistics, Reliability, Computational Cognitive Science and Software Engineering); (iv) automatizing and optimizing multifaceted cutting-edge industrial applications such as welding, industrial robots, manufacturing, transportation, and oil sand mining. My diverse educational background (Bachelor of Mechanical Engineering, Master in Quality, Reliability and Operations Research (QROR) as well as Master and PhD in Computer Science) facilitates me to conduct research in a broad range of interdisciplinary areas. Highlights of my research contributions are mentioned below.

Machine Learning and Computer Vision in Manufacturing Industry

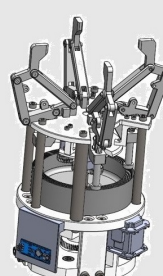
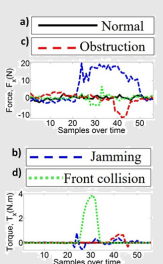
The nature of manufacturing systems faces ever more complex, dynamic and at times even chaotic behaviors. In order to being able to satisfy the demand for high-quality products in an efficient manner, it is essential to utilize all means available. One area, which saw fast pace developments in terms of not only promising results but also usability, is machine learning. In order to meet the challenges of ever-growing demand for high-quality products in an efficient manner, modern industry practices are being supported by integrating cyber-physical systems, biotechnology and emerging digital technologies such as remote sensing, cloud computing, cognitive computing, and Internet of Things (IoT), leading to the notion of "Industria 4.0" or "Smart Manufacturing" or "Smart Factory". These emerging digital technologies contribute to better analyzing and understanding complex, multivariate and unpredictable production systems by monitoring and measuring continuously variable aspects of the physical environment. As a result of these, nowadays industry is experiencing an unforeseen plethora of available data comprising a variety of different formats, semantics, quality, e. g. sensor data from the production line, environmental data, machine tool parameters and such others. This implies a pressing need for large-scale collection, storage, pre-processing, modeling and analysis of huge amounts of data, coming from various heterogeneous sources and leading to the notion of "Big Data". The availability of quality-related data offers potential to improve process and product quality sustainably, quality improvement initiatives, manufacturing cost estimation, process optimization e.g., monitoring, control, scheduling, diagnostics, troubleshooting and overall better understanding of the customer's requirements. Highlights of my contributions in manufacturing are mentioned below.

Development of Machine Learning (Data Driven) based Controller

Many industrial tasks performed by robots require position-force control. In practice, engineers have to tune the force control gains on a case by case basis, in order to adapt to the different stiffness, damping or clearance of work pieces (environment). In contrast to the non-trivial gain tuning of conventional controller, since data-driven learning allows to reduce the amount of engineering knowledge, we advocate a different approach and speed up learning by extracting more information from data. In particular, we learn a probabilistic, non-parametric Gaussian process transition model of the system. By explicitly incorporating model uncertainty into long-term planning and controller learning our approach reduces the effect of model errors, a key problem in model-based learning. It turned out that proposed technique leads to a significant improvement over knowledge-based solutions. The reason is that the machine learning is not limited by the imagination of an expert, but is directly evaluating the process behavior instead. In addition, data driven controller outperforms in unforeseen situations.

Combining Sensors to Improve the Accuracy of the Controller

Designing Arduino based controller for controlling the level of the water in the tank using ultrasonic sensor is a well-known problem. I with my students have incorporated multiple sensors: ultrasonic, visual sensor (camera) and temperature sensor to control the level and temperature of the water in the tank which in turn increase the accuracy of the controller. Similarly, following line automatically by robot is a popular research problem which has several applications such as, (i) industrial: automated equipment carriers replacing traditional conveyor belts; (ii) automobile: automatic cars running on roads with

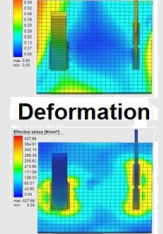


Gripper

Weld-
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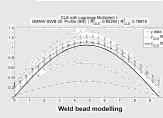
Workpiece



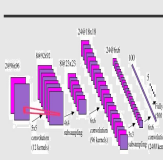
Stress



WAAM



DCNN



SRL



embedded magnets; (iii) domestic: floor cleaning; and (iv) guidance: public places like shopping malls, museums etc to provide path guidance. The strength of our algorithm is that we developed a Raspberry based controller using multiple sensors: infrared, camera and ultrasonic that can deviate from the line in the presence of obstacles and again return and follow the line. We implemented camera calibration algorithm and utilized kalman filter to combine multiple sensors.

Automation of Industrial Robots for Manufacturing Operations

Automatizing Peg-Hole Insertion Task by Industrial Robot: Parts mating, peg in hole insertion or assembly operation is the most common operation in industry production, but autonomous execution by robots can significantly increase overall productivity. Peg in hole insertion task is a topic largely addressed and long standing problem in robotic research, the popularity of which is not only due to its importance in many industrial assembly tasks, but also for its complexity as a control problem that requires both position and force regulation. We developed both computer vision and without computer vision based algorithms to automate the peg in hole insertion task. We implemented a fast template matching algorithm and followed by non-linear camera calibration method to automatically finding the peg and hole in the complex working environment [17]. However, occlusion and imprecise sensor make the automation task difficult in several occasions. Hence, we portrayed the problem of peg in hole insertion search as a travelling salesman based grid search problem and we automatically look for the work pieces through force-torque sensor built in robot end-effector. Then, we developed both impedance and machine learning based controller for regulating force control. We also offered fast and accurate convergence of robot inverse kinematic solutions by incorporating domain knowledge into novel multi-objective genetic and differential evolution algorithms [18]. We executed the real experiment on Motoman MH-6, gantry or cartesian, and Crustcrawler AX-18 industrial robot. We also facilitated the use of Motoman SDA-20 dual-arm robot equipped with two three fingered gripper and a force/torque sensing capability for human like operations such as the peg-in-hole tasks by learning contact states using ANN Fuzzy ARTMAP architecture.

Design a Novel Adaptive and Reconfigurable Robot Gripper using FEM: In another effort, with one of my master students, we developed and implemented a novel Finite Element Method (FEM) based modelling for single degree-of-freedom adaptive and reconfigurable four -fingered robot gripper for automating industrial applications. FEM based deformation and stress analysis facilitates: (a) minimizing the cost of the gripper by selecting cost-effective material that can grab a wide range of objects, and (b) estimating the remaining useful life of the critical components through fatigue analysis.

Probabilistic Visual Slam: We developed a modified Extended Kalman filter and particle filter algorithm as well as we exploited weighted Harris Corner and Sift based point features for visual Simultaneous Localization And Mapping (SLAM) algorithm. We evaluated the performance of our SLAM implementation from two perspectives. First, we compared the robot's estimated trajectory with respect to the ground truth. Second, we evaluated the quality of the generated map by comparing distances between landmarks suggested by the generated map with the corresponding physical distances. Our results illustrate that the estimated distances between landmarks are reasonably close to the groundtruth. Also, the relative distance estimated between selected landmarks in the map converges to a stable value which is close the ground truth.

Automation and Optimization of Welding Process

Welding Sequence Optimization: Welding is the most common fabrication process which is extensively used in a wide range of industries such as automotive, shipbuilding, aerospace, pipelines, heavy and earth-moving equipment. Welding deformation and effective (residual) stress derive several negative impact to the manufacturing process and add additional cost in various ways, such as constraints in the design phase, extra operations, cost of quality and overall capital expenditure. With one of my PhD students, we developed novel modified Lowest Cost Graph Search (LCGS) [19], multi-objective Genetic Algorithm (GA) [14] as well as Reinforcement Learning (RL) [15] based Welding Sequence Optimization (WSO) techniques for reducing welding deformation and residual stress. We first demonstrated in literature the effectiveness of WSO using the the combination of conventional and Low Temperature Transformation (LTT) welding wires in the same weldment. LTT increases the fatigue life by introducing compressive residual stresses.

Vision based Automated Welding Quality Inspection: The computer visual tracking of free-flight metal transfer is an important part in the high-quality industrial welding. However, the main difficulty in using visual inspection to evaluate the weld quality is the time taken and labor wasted. In order to solve these problems, an automated vision-based system is presented for non-destructive and online post-welding quality inspection. The trouble with respect to vision-based system is the robustness of image processing algorithms. We developed an active contour followed by Kalman filter algorithm for computer visual tracking from high speed videos of free-flight metal transfer.

Mathematical Modelling of Weld Bead in WAAM: We developed a novel nonlinear regression followed by Taguchi method for modelling of welding bead geometry in Wire and Arc Additive Manufacturing (WAAM). WAAM has been evolved as an alternative to traditional manufacturing specially for fabricating large aerospace metal components that feature high buy-to-fly ratios. Bead modelling determines the optimum weld settings corresponding to the desired bead geometry. The strength, density and homogeneity of the deposited material depends on the bead geometry. Controlling the bead geometry of the workpiece is much easier and is used to predict its mechanical properties.

Virtual Training for Welder through Augmented and Virtual Reality: Virtual training is a vital way of educating technicians to make them prepared for real maintenance work. We developed a Virtual Maintenance Trainer (VMT) for welders, which can provide a detailed simulation of the welding process during operation. The welders are able to complete courses and

lessons with specific procedures such as calculation of welding nozzle angle, optimal sequence of welding bead, and weld speed. This study explores virtual and augmented reality as an education tools. The advantages and disadvantages of current implementations are examined to provide an optimal system which could work to give welders a realistic practical training simulation experience.

Combining and Classifying Multiple Sensor Data

A Prognostic Model for Critical Components of a Hydraulic System: The growing need to increase the competitiveness of industrial systems requires a reduction of maintenance costs, without compromising safe plant operation. Therefore, forecasting the future behavior of a system or component allows more optimal maintenance planning and cost savings, because unexpected repairs and downtime can be avoided. More generally, the prediction of future failures can provide key information to the decision-making process. Prognostics is an emerging science of predicting the health condition of a system and/or its components, based upon current and previous system status. On-line predictive maintenance is a new maintenance philosophy involving real-time analysis of equipment sensor data to infer maintenance condition or health. Maintenance activities are then performed on the basis of necessity, as identified by a predictive maintenance system. In this study we divide the health status of an equipment into three stages: normal, transition, and failure. We developed a novel support vector machine based online control chart to identify as soon as the health status of an equipment changes from normal to transition state so that the longevity of the equipment can be extended through performing predictive maintenance.

Remaining Useful Life (RUL) for Bearing: Failure prognostic activity aims at anticipating the failure date by predicting the future health state of a given component, sub-system or system and its Remaining Useful Life (RUL). This research deals with a data-driven diagnostic and prognostic method based on a Mixture of Gaussians Hidden Markov Model. The prognostic process of the proposed method is made in two steps. In the first step, which is performed offline, the monitoring data provided by sensors are processed to extract features, which are then used to learn different models that capture the time evolution of the degradation and therefore of the system's health state. In the second step, performed online, the learned models are exploited to perform failure diagnostic and prognostic by estimating the asset's current health state, its remaining useful life and the associated confidence degree. The efficiency of our method is tested on a benchmark data related to several bearings.

Vibration Analysis as well as Detection and Suppression of Drilling Chatter: Chatter is a kind of self-induced vibration common in the metal-cutting. In the precision machining process, the effective suppression of cutting chatter is of great significance for processing accuracy, surface finish and tool life. During drilling operation, When the rotational frequency becomes equal to the natural frequency, chattering occurs. To avoid cutting chatter effectively, we develop two different methods for chatter identification before it has fully developed. Vibration of the system is recorded through accelerometers. First we exploit wavelet transform, which can image the information in both the time and frequency domain is passed through a Convolutional Neural Network (CNN) for the early detection of chatter. In another method, we developed a novel kalman filter based online control chart to monitor the vibration and detect the chatter from its inception. Kalman filter is used to combine multiple sensors.

Monitoring and Controlling the Temperature of an Industrial Furnace: In this study, we advocate a data driven adaptive PID controller for the optimal temperature control of an industrial furnace. Our proposal involves a two step procedure for the prediction of the temperature and the estimation of the optimal values of control variables. In the prediction step, we use a machine learning approach based on neural networks to predict the temperature change due to certain changes in the amount of the control parameters. In the optimization step, we use a meta heuristic algorithm based on Differential Evolution to find the optimal values of the control parameters to reach the furnace temperature equal to the set point temperature at each time point at different area of the furnace. The effectiveness of our proposal is shown in data from an experiment with an industrial furnace.

Machine Learning, Soft Computing, and Big Data

A plethora of emerging Big Data applications such as, social media analysis, video surveillance, network security monitoring, personalized and precision medicine, genomics, neuroscience, economics, finance, and such others, usher processing and analyzing streams of data to extract valuable information in real-time. Big Data hold great promises for discovering subtle population patterns and heterogeneities that are not possible with small-scale data. On the other hand, the massive sample size and high dimensionality of Big Data introduce unique computational and statistical challenges: (i) high dimensionality brings noise accumulation, spurious correlations and incidental homogeneity; (ii) high dimensionality combined with large sample size creates issues such as heavy computational cost and algorithmic instability; (iii) the massive samples in Big Data are typically aggregated from multiple sources at different time points using different technologies. This creates issues of heterogeneity, experimental variations and statistical biases, and requires us to develop more adaptive and robust procedures. These challenges are distinguished and require new computational and statistical paradigm. In terms of statistical accuracy, dimension reduction and variable selection play pivotal roles in analyzing high-dimensional data. This motivates advancement of new regularization methods and sure independence screening. In terms of computational efficiency, Big Data motivate the development of new computational infrastructure and data-storage methods. Such a paradigm change has led to significant progresses on developments of fast algorithms that are scalable to massive data with high dimensionality. My research interests lie in capacitating classification algorithms for handling Big data by incorporating data-driven regularization strategy which improves classification accuracy by avoiding overfitting and expediting the convergence. Details are given below.

SVM

BN

GA

RL

PCA

Big-Data

Adaptive Regularized Boosting (AR-Boost): Adaboost is one of the state-of-the-art classifiers for two class classification. I developed a novel Adaptive Regularized Boosting (AR-Boost) by incorporating a regularization parameter into the boosting loss function that relaxes the *weak learner assumption* of boosting algorithm and thus facilitates a natural extension of boosting algorithm for multiclass setting [12]. I advocated a regularized exponential loss function for AR-Boost which enforces more weight than Adaboost on misclassified samples at each iteration to classify correctly in the immediate iteration and consequently leads to early convergence. Unlike Adaboost, the user can select optimal weights of the features through cross-validation. Currently, I am deploying AR-Boost for pediatric brain age classification from MRI which can help in early non-invasive diagnosis and prognosis of abnormal pediatric brain development.

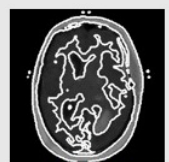
kNN Regularized Support Vector Machine (kNN-SVM): We describe a novel approach to combining the properties of two well-known formalisms: k-Nearest Neighbors (kNN) and Support Vector Machines (SVMs). We introduce a k-Nearest Neighbor (kNN) based regularization term into SVM optimization framework which improves the classification accuracy of SVM by leveraging the strengths of both SVM and kNN. The proposed loss function minimizes the slackness and maximizes the surplus, provides weights to the slack variables based on the degree of their k-NN and thus introduces a novel regularization strategy into SVM framework. Our approach extends the total margin SVM, which considers the distance of all points from the margin; each point is weighted based on its k neighbors. The intuition is that examples that are mostly surrounded by similar neighbors, i.e., of their own class, are given more priority to minimize the influence of drastic outliers and improve generalization and robustness. Thus, our approach combines the local sensitivity of kNN with the global stability of the total-margin SVM. We analyzed its theoretical properties and empirically demonstrate improved generalization and robustness in noisy settings for both binary and multi class classification. We are now extending the idea of kNN-SVM in Big Data domain by ameliorating the bottlenecks of kNN in high dimensional framework.

Bayesian Network (BN) Classifier: Motivated by the success of Bayesian Classifier with strong assumptions of independence among features, called Naive Bayes (NB), we deployed Bayesian Network (BN) Classifier with slightly less restrictive assumptions of independence among features, called Tree Augmented Naive Bayes (TAN) to classify successfully the robot execution failures associated with automation of peg in hole insertion task by Industria Robot, Motoman MH-6 [13]. TAN approximates the interactions between attributes by using a tree structure imposed on the NB structure that generalize the NB classifier and explicitly represent statements about independence which outperforms Naive Bayes, yet at the same time maintains the computational simplicity (no search involved) and robustness that characterize NB.

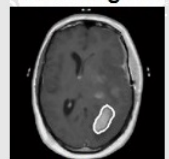
Exploiting Domain Knowledge for Early Convergence of Genetic Algorithm (GA): Genetic algorithms (GAs) are a heuristic search and optimisation technique inspired by natural evolution. They have been successfully applied to a wide range of real-world problems of significant complexity. Success of GA depends on smart choice of selection, crossover and mutation mechanism and fitness function as well. We advocated domain knowledge in selection, crossover and mutation algorithms that expedites the convergence and makes GA more robust for combinatorial optimization problems. We developed a novel restricted weak integer composition based sample initialization algorithm which introduce diversity in the population and in turn increases likelihood of convergence for solving progressive censoring through GA. In another effort, Algebraic Method (AM) is a well known analytical method for robot inverse kinematic problem. However, this method demonstrates poor convergence rate and falls into local minima in many occasions. We developed a GA based solution where AM has been introduced to reduce the search space and thus helps in speeding up the convergence rate for GA. Like Differential Evolution (DE), we introduced a novel vector differential based crossover algorithm in both binary and continuous domains which increases the likelihood of finding global optima. We also advocated data driven parameter optimization method for GA [14]. We are now performing parallel and online implementation for GA to offer realtime solutions.

Tailoring Classification Algorithm for Big Data: Support Vector Machines (SVMs) are currently the state-of-the-art models for many classification problems but they suffer from the complexity of their training algorithm which is at least quadratic with respect to the number of examples. Conventional Sequential Minimization Method (SMO) is not computationally efficient for using Support Vector Machine (SVM) for large scale problems. We are conducting research on facilitating SVM for solving large scale problems using coordinate descent method. We are also introducing the idea of mixture of experts, divide and conquer, Bayesian committee machine, and MapReduce algorithms in classification algorithms such as SVM, AdaBoost, and Decision Tree for enabling them tackle to Big Data where training data is divided into a number of clusters, run training algorithm on each of the cluster separately and parallelly and then amalgamate them to generate the training model using the mixture of experts. In an alternative procedure, we are implementing a novel clustering based sampling techniques to generate a representative sample of the Big data and perform training algorithm on the sample instead of the whole large dataset to alleviate massive computation.

To Improve Medical Diagnosis through Decision Tree: In medical decision making (classification, diagnosing, etc.) there are many situations where decision must be made effectively and reliably. Conceptual simple decision making models with the possibility of automatic learning are the most appropriate for performing such tasks. Decision trees are a reliable and effective decision making technique that provide high classification accuracy with a simple representation of gathered knowledge and they have been used in different areas of medical decision making. In addition, automated decision making models developed for medical applications need to be interpretable akin to decision tree that help medical practitioners for making diagnostic and prognostic decisions for treating diseases. We are deploying decision tree for making diagnostic decisions for Non-Alcoholic Fatty Liver Disease (NAFLD). Automated decision tree can successfully diagnose NAFLD in

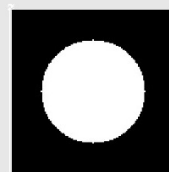


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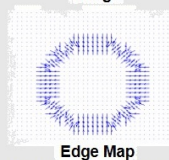


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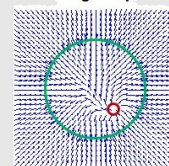
Snake



Image

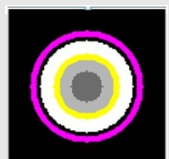


Edge Map

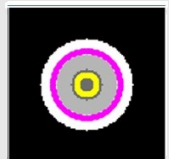


Diffusion with Dirichlet boundary condition

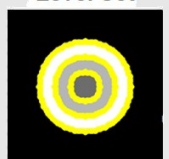
HLS



Initialization



Level Set



Hierarchical Level Set



96% cases using only biochemical features. However, the conventional clinically-oriented metabolic feature based decision tree developed by exploiting the knowledge of the physician (domain expert) can classify accurately only in 70% cases. We implemented lookahead decision tree that can compensate immediate wrong decision as well as incorporate induction of XOR along with conjunction and disjunction.

Improving exploration in Reinforcement Learning (RL) through Domain Knowledge: We presented a novel work on how to improve exploration in reinforcement learning using domain knowledge and knowledge-based approaches to reinforcement learning. Reinforcement learning algorithms normally face the problem of deciding whether to execute explorative or exploitative actions, and the paramount goal is to limit the number of executions of suboptimal explorative actions. We achieve this through better understanding of domain knowledge and understanding of algorithms' and domains' properties. We incorporated the knowledge of thermal affected zone and joint rigidity of the system while solving welding sequence optimization through RL [15]. At present, we are deploying monte carlo tree search for welding sequence optimization where exploration-exploitation dilemma is being balanced by UCB (Upper Confidence Bound).

Deep Reinforcement Learning (DRL): Motivated by unprecedented success of human level control through DRL [16], we are conducting research on developing a novel object detection algorithm through DRL. The agent (proposed DRL based object detection algorithm) automatically learns a policy which computes the probability of taking an action (translation and scale) in every state so that the agent can reach to the final state (desired object circumscribed by the bounding box) from the initial state (the whole image itself is circumscribed by the bounding box). DRL is adept in reducing run time complexity without compromising the detection accuracy by avoiding searches in the areas where the probability of having objects is very low. The agent constructs a deep learning feature representation of the current state (bounding box), which is then used by the Deep Q-Network (DQN) to determine the next suitable course of action so that the goal can be achieved very quickly. We are also working for developing DRL based model for robot inverse kinematic problem and peg in hole automation. Reduction of state space is one of main challenges in these problems which are being handled through DRL.

Computer Vision, and Image Processing

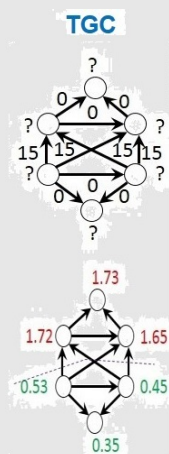
I developed several novel image segmentation, and tracking algorithms. Very few of them are mentioned below.

Smart Document Digitization: In this research, we develop a smart platform for digitizing, storing and managing inspection report of manufacturing operations. Document digitization replaces paper based inspection checklists with digital forms which optimizes internal business processes, better compliance, reduce paper use, human error, ensure accuracy, and increase operational efficiency. We deploy both Optical Mark Recognition (OMR) and Optical Character Recognition (OCR) methods to digitize manufacturing inspection reports. Improper paper handling such as twisting or folding the paper by the workers applies deformation on the QR (Quick Response) code and damage the regular shape of the QR which is almost unrecoverable by the available software. We exploit deep learning through variational autoencoder based QR code recover algorithm which outperforms state-of-the-art techniques.

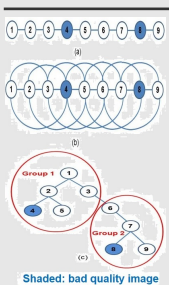
Automatic Validation of the Screenless Crusher technology for Oil Sand Mining: Alberta oil sands are a vital energy source for Canada and the world. Alberta's energy resources are the backbone of the economy of the province and the world. Mining operation is the first step toward oil extraction from oil sand. Once the topsoil and vegetation is removed, shovels are brought in to dig, scoop overburden first and then oil sand, which is filled into large haul trucks. These haul trucks ferry oil sand to the remote crusher plant site in the traditional surface mining technology. Ongoing research on this technology envisages a mobile crusher where haul trucks will be eliminated from the system and the shovels can directly dump oil sand into the hopper of the crusher that can move around. This will entail into significant savings on operation and maintenance of haul trucks. The aim of developing this technology is to use a new type of crushing system that will not generate any rejects and is therefore expensive vibrating screen is no longer needed to sieve unexpected crushed but bigger oil sand particles from rest of the smaller particles and to reject those bigger particles. Thus this technology will economize the oil sand production cost.

To automatically verify the design of the crusher in the prototype of this technology, the output of the crusher is transported and is sieved through the screen. The undersize particles are sent to Primary Separation Vessel (PSV) and the oversize particles are rejected. Images of those rejected oil sand particles are acquired by the video camera mounted over conveyor belt located after the screen. These images are segmented by the automatic snake based segmentation technique proposed in this research and the size of each oil sand particle is measured.

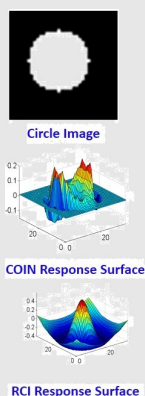
Automation of Active Contour or Snake Algorithm: Snake is revered as state-of-the-art interactive segmentation algorithm for microscopic cell images. The introductory paper on snake has secured more than nineteen thousand google scholar citations till date (February 2018) [3]. However, snake fails to delineate object boundaries in many real-life applications which urge automation. Literature demonstrates that snake automation needs two sequential steps: initialization and evolution. However we ameliorated snake automation by integrating a self-validation mechanism into snake segmentation framework to revolutionize snake from interactive to automatic segmentation. We fostered three novel algorithms towards snake segmentation: (a) A quadtree or Fast Bounding Box (FBB) based fast object localization method to initialize snake; (b) Interleave Directional Gradient Vector Flow (IDGVF) where novelty lies in two fronts: (i) instills Dirichlet Boundary Condition (DBC) into existing snake evolution algorithm which transmutes the gradient field anisotropic and snake is manifested as more initialization independent; (ii) computation of gradient or force field and snake evolution algorithm is performed concurrently



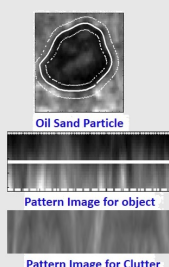
MST



RCI



PI



in an interleaved fashion which fortifies snake over noises; (iii) evolved snake is sieved through a classifier such as Principal Component Analysis (PCA) or Adaptive Regularized Boosting (AR-Boost) which determines whether delineated region is a desired object and snake is revitalized as an automatic segmentation algorithm for multiple blob-object segmentation [4]. These methods have been successfully deployed in a number of applications, namely brain tumor, edema and white matter lesion detection from MRI, leukocyte and cell detection from histopathological images, and sundries.

Hierarchical Level Set (HLS): Level set has been manifested as a successful image segmentation algorithm for many applications. The prelude article of level set segmentation algorithm has bagged more than eleven thousand google scholar citations till date (February 2018) [5]. However, Level set typically creates two partitions and fails in many applications which demands more partitions. I have developed a Hierarchical Level Set (HLS) algorithm that implements tiered iterative level sets based on residual variation to capture multiple partitions. HLS can successfully capture White Matter Lesions (WML) of various types from structural brain Magnetic Resonance Imaging (MRI) [6]. WML are thought to reflect chronic microvascular ischemic disease and often develop in persons with type 2 diabetes. We conducted a comparative study between the cerebrovascular disease (CBVD) with type 2 diabetes among European Americans (EA) and African Americans (AA) as a part of the NIH R01 grants (DHS-MIND and AADHS-MIND). Quantitative analysis of WML in large clinical trials can improve diagnosis and prognosis of the CBVD.

Fast Topological Graph Cut (TGC): We exploit the topological concept of cohomology to develop a fast graph cut based image segmentation algorithm which runs in linear time ($O(N)$). We demonstrate that for a graph, if the differential map of the function on vertices is equal to the function on edges then the function on vertices can correctly classify the vertices. Proposed algorithm first generates an oriented simplicial complex representation of an image. Next, we develop and implement a ranking algorithm which prioritizes the nodes of the weighted graph based on the similarity by solving a set of linear equations of the function on vertices in linear time. We propose a directional derivative approach to search for the function on vertices that are close to the function on weights. The differential map of the function on vertices yields the matrix of the linear matrix ranking system a simple symmetric matrix that leads the computation of the inverse of the matrix trivial and thus finds the solution of the generalized linear matrix system in linear time. Finally, we implement a standard clustering algorithm on the rank of the nodes given by the proposed ranking algorithm. We demonstrate that this proposed ranking technique has several advantages over state-of-the-art graph cut methods: (i) the proposed method is computationally attractive; it executes in linear time; (ii) the method discovers the topological properties of the first cohomology class of the function on the weights of the graph edges that leads to an efficient graph based classifier; (iii) the proposed method performs well on super pixels; (iv) it has the ability to provide a stable segmentation under noisy conditions. Proposed algorithm obtains state-of-the-art performance.

Variational Thresholding (VT): Thresholding is a well-known pre-processing step for image segmentation. It is widely used in automatic target recognition, industrial applications of computer visions and medical/biomedical image analysis. We introduced a locally adaptive image thresholding technique via minimax optimization of a novel energy functional that consists of a non-linear convex combination of an edge sensitive data fidelity term and a regularization term [7]. While the proposed data fidelity term requires the threshold surface to intersect the image surface only at places with large image gradient magnitude, the regularization term enforces smoothness in the threshold surface. To the best of our knowledge, all the previously proposed energy functional-based adaptive image thresholding algorithms rely on manually set weighting parameters to achieve a balance between the data fidelity and the regularization terms. In contrast, we use minimax principle to automatically find this weighting parameter value, as well as the threshold surface. Our conscious choice of the energy functional permits a variational formulation within the minimax principle leading to a globally optimum solution. The proposed variational minimax optimization is carried out by an iterative gradient descent with exact line search technique that we experimentally demonstrate to be computationally far more attractive than the Fibonacci search applied to find the minimax solution. Our method shows promising results to preserve edge/texture structures in different benchmark images over other competing methods.

Deep Convolutional Neural Network (D-CNN): In recent years, D-CNNs have achieved great success in many problems of machine learning and computer vision due to plethora of computational power and data availability. We have implemented the idea of user interactive segmentation by random walk on a complete graph where feature vectors are learned through convnet. We developed and implemented a novel D-CNN based completely automated image segmentation algorithm where the novelty lies in two fronts: doing random walk on a complete graph and learning feature for similarity measurement by convnet. Proposed algorithm obtains state-of-the-art performance.

Statistical Relational Learning (SRL): We developed a SRL based classifier for three class classification of Alzheimer disease [1]. SRL is a natural choice of model relations, it can find the relationship between the different regions of the brain representing the classes Alzheimer Disease (AD), Cognitively Normal (CN), and Mild Cognitive Impairment (MCI). Our extensive experiments demonstrate that Statistical Relational Learning (SRL) outperforms propositional classifier such as Support Vector Machine (SVM), Decision Tree (DT) for AD classification. In future, SRL can be used for modeling, analyzing and simulating complex brain networks helping diagnosis and treatment plan for a lot of diseases and thus Artificial intelligence initiates a new horizon in personalized medicine.

Fast Bounding Box (FBB) Method: Currently, many clinical centers maintain large archival databases of Magnetic

Losses (log scale) vs. iterations for different models: Microclassification, Exponential, Logistic, Squared, and Proposed.

SVM

Normal SVM

Proposed KNN-SVM

BN

Naïve Bayes Structure

TAN Structure

GA

GA

RL

RL

PCA

PCA

Big-Data

Big-Data

Data

Data

Resonance (MR) images of brain tumors for various purposes, as this information may help physicians and radiologists to diagnose and treat new patients - e. g., by determining the effectiveness of various treatments on previous patients with similar tumor or edema volumes. As these archived MR image databases may contain a large number of studies, it is important to index their contents effectively. If these tumors were segmented, the databases could be indexed based on various aspects of the tumor, such as its size, location and type. However, accurate tumor boundary delineation is a very complex task to be accomplished accurately. We have developed an automatic, fast, and approximate segmentation technique that deals with the problem associated with accurate tumor segmentation, by locating a “bounding box” - i.e., axis-parallel rectangles, around the tumor or edema on a magnetic resonance slice exploiting the left-right symmetry of human brain [2]. We can then use this bounding box to determine tumor position, type and size to retrieve historical cases relevant to the current patient and help formulate treatment plans using deep learning. The resulting method is very fast, robust and reliable for indexing tumor or edema images for both archival and retrieval purposes and it can be used as a vehicle for further clinical investigations. Our papers received more than one hundred and twenty google scholar citations till date (February 2018).

My future endeavor involves extending such techniques even to objects having low boundary contrast, so that automated active contour algorithms would capcitate delineate object boundaries under poor lighting conditions (which is prevalent in many typical industrial setups) and from low-contrast cellular/molecular imagery. One of my other future works include developing generalized object detection and tracking framework by incorporating self-validation mechanism with spatiotemporal features. One of its significant applications include cell detection and tracking. We are also intending to address few more important questions such as: can we have an unsupervised or semi-supervised classification paradigm for this self-validation mechanism for automatic segmentation? Undoubtedly, the unsupervised/semi-supervised learning can curtail the difficulties of frequent supervised learning in applications where object characteristics change considerably and frequently.

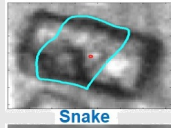
Optimal Sequence Selection for Deformable Registration: Significant cardiac and respiratory motion of the living subject, occasional spells of defocus, drifts in the field of view, and long image sequences make the registration of *in-vivo* microscopy image sequences an onerous task. We developed and implemented a novel two-stage Minimum Spanning Tree (MST)-based clustering method for deformable registration of microscopy image sequences [8]. We first construct a MST for the input image sequence. MST mitigates the registration error propagation of time sequenced images by re-ordering the images in such a way where poor quality images appear at the end of the sequence. Then, MST is clustered into several groups based on the similarity of the images. After that, an optimal anchor image is selected automatically for each group through an iterative assessment of entropy and MSE based coarse registration error and the local deformable registration is performed within each group separately. Subsequently, coarse registration is conducted to find the global anchor image selected among the whole time sequenced images and then a deformable registration is conducted on the whole sequence. Two-stage MST-based deformable registration algorithm can incorporate larger drifts and distortions more accurately than conventional one shot registration algorithm by fine-tuning the larger amount of deformation incrementally in a couple of stages. Our method outperforms other methods on both 2D and 3D microscopy image sequences of mouse arteries used in atherosclerosis study.

Inclusion Filter (IF): We developed inclusion filter which is used to remove noises and fill the holes from the images before applying the segmentation algorithm [9]. The design of inclusion filters is motivated by self-duality. Self-duality (gray-level inversion invariance) is a desired criterion for many real-life applications, such as oil sand mining where objects appear as both darker and brighter than the background. The inclusion filter is a special class of connected filters which removes minor interior regions and clutter based on the connected component relationships defined by the adjacency forest. Connected filters offer important edge-preserving qualities which is very critical for segmentation. We demonstraed that the use of the inclusion filter significantly improves the edge fidelity and the insensitivity to initialization of active contour or snake algorithm for the oil sand and lung cavity segmentation from magnetic resonance imagery.

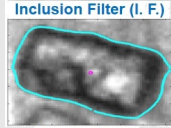
Robust Convergence Index Filter (RCI): CONvergence INdex (COIN) filter, a successful tool for cell localization, evaluates the degree of convergence of the gradient vectors within the neighborhood (region of support) toward a pixel of interest. All previous efforts were to increase the adaptability of the region of support to make the COIN filter robust and accurate. However, improving the quality of the image gradient map was ignored, which results in poor performance of the members of the COIN family in noisy settings. We developed a new Robust Convergence Index (RCI) filter that tailors the COIN filter in a noisy environment by (a) spreading the gradient vectors within non-homogeneous object regions by convolving an Aggregated Edge Probability Map (AEPM) with an edge preserving gradient vector kernel, and (b) increasing the convergence of the gradient vectors through the integration of the sine and cosine distribution as well as the magnitude of the gradient vectors [10]. AEPM is computed through the consensus of the responses of a number of edge detectors over a wide range of scales, which lessens the effects of clutter by enforcing higher weights to the actual edges, and a non-parametric Kernel Density Estimation (KDE) is used to compute the edge probability map. RCI obtains state-of-the-art performance on histopathological breast cancer cell imagery.

Pattern Image (PI): I developed a novel image feature that has been named as “Pattern Image” that could detect objects successfully under noisy settings. “Pattern Image” unfolds the annular band across the object boundaries to form a rectangular pattern for computational convenience that can discriminate successfully objects (leukocyte cells from *in-vivo* microscopic images used for inflammation study and oil sand particles useful for oil sand mining applications) from clutter [11]. This proposed pattern image carries texture information as well as intensity transition (dark to bight transition and vice versa) across regions of object boundaries and it outperforms other edge based features such as Gradient Inverse

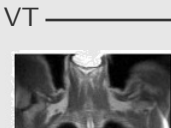
IF



Snake



Inclusion Filter (I. F.)

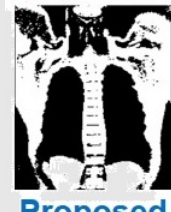


Snake on I. F.

VT



Proton MRI

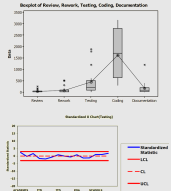


Proposed

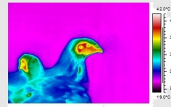


Otsu

SW

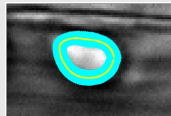


IP





PI



Pattern Image

Coefficient Of Variation (GICOV), Average gradient strength and sundries.

Biologically Relevant Features (BRF): We devised novel biologically relevant features useful for predicting breast cancer disease survival and recurrence from histopathological images. Towards achieving this goal, we developed three mathematical features such as (a) *Deviation from ellipticity*, (b) *Cell co-location pattern*, and (c) *Mitotic count* that translates three distinct biologically relevant features (i) *cellular pleomorphism*, (ii) *tubule formation* (randomness and abnormal aberrations of the epithelial cell structure), and (iii) *mitosis* that indicates the presence of cancer respectively. Pathologists determine the grade of the cancer of the patients based on these biologically relevant features. Our mathematical features could replicate the grading offered by pathologists that could avoid the inter- and intra-observer variability and predict the breast cancer disease survival and recurrence from histopathological images.

Imaging Genomics in Cancer Research

In recent years, a new direction in cancer research referred to as "radiogenomics or imaging genomics" has emerged to address methodologies of associating imaging features (imaging phenotype or radiophenotype) with genomic data (molecular phenotype or genotype). Recently, I received a basic science research grant for three years to find the potential association between imaging phenotype and genotype for the treatment of breast cancer. Late stage patients clearly benefit from more aggressive treatments such as chemotherapy, while for early stage patients the toxicity of the treatment may predominate the benefit. Early-stage cancers are the target of the Oncotype DX (genomic) test to find distinct subgroups within the early-stage group with different recurrence probabilities that urge for chemotherapy. However, the Oncotype DX test is very expensive but histological imaging is less expensive. We study that both histopathological findings and molecular alterations that reflect the biological properties of individual primary breast carcinomas and they demonstrate strong association among them. Prognostic decisions with only histological imaging for early stage patients could reduce the treatment cost significantly. We advocate Deep CNN to delve the potential associations among imaging and genomic biomarkers.

Computational Cognitive Science

As a statistician it was a matter of curiosity for me to measure mental and psychological processes. Statistical models are being applied to various disciplines outside engineering. Another thematically distinctive area of research is Applied Psychology. I felt motivated to develop statistical models, and also understand how socio-psychological processes in behavior may be predicted. This kind of research also has relevance for artificial intelligence and computational systems of perception and simulation. I participated in experiment design and analysis for three different studies: (i) color perception: we evaluate cognitive perception of the different segments of the population on the color "Rosa Mexicano", which is widely used in art, fashion, painting, architecture, and crafts [20]; (ii) statistical measurement of perception in interactive game: we designed an interactive media to check whether a short real time intervention could act as a mood changer for adolescents, in a stressful learning scenarios such as classroom and respondents' reaction were collected on a combined psychological emotional-valence scale [21]; and (iii) Computer Generated Biological Imagery (CGBI) to stimulate horripilation: we studied the specific effect of visual imagery of physical sensational horror which aims at evoking effects of chills, or goosebumps involving nervous shudder and withdrawal from objects of contemplation. Statistical tools and techniques (factor analysis, ANOVA), visualization (pie-bubble chart), and image processing algorithms have been implemented in these projects.

Industrial Research

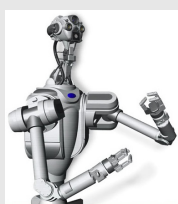
Image Processing: I was awarded MITACS Canada industrial internship award three times during my doctoral studies, where I worked on the projects dealing with (i) the early detection/classification of sick birds from thermal images; and (ii) Automatic passenger counting from Light Railway Transit in Edmonton. In the light of different food-related viruses, it is absolutely critical to have a reliable early detection method in the food supply industries/animal farm. My responsibility was to image acquisition (mount web camera at the ceiling and grab the top views to minimize occlusion). I developed a novel variational thresholding method to delineate the warmer regions around the tympanic member of the chicken that is used as a non-invasive biomarker for early detection of Flu. I also implemented parametric curve to automatically detect the passenger heads, followed by optical flow based tracking algorithm and finally validation algorithm to minimize false positive.

Statistical Software Engineering: I completed several industrial projects including: (i) A graph theoretic approach to assess the quality of the class of object oriented software on the basis of a set of metrics and developing a new metric by incorporating the class dependency information; (ii) A bootstrapping method to estimate the efforts required to fix the number of bugs reported by the customer; (iii) A Bayesian approach to evaluate methodology for establishing baselines of build efforts on the basis of SAC (Simple/Average/Complex) methodology; (iv) An integer programming based optimization algorithm for software test case selection; and (v) A regression based software defect prediction methodology.

Quality Control and Reliability: Currently I am supervising a group of students in several industrial projects that include: (i) Statistical tools and techniques (pareto analysis, nonparametric control chart and sampling plan) for visual inspection of electronic chip making process; (ii) A multiple sensor based Hiddell Markov Model (HMM) for estimating Remaining Useful Life (RUL) of the critical components of a hydraulic system; and (iii) Online removal of chattering by monitoring and detecting natural frequency for a robot guided drill system through kalman filter based control chart.

Future Research Plan

In the long term of my research career, I am interested to solve application-driven large scale (complex) image analysis. In my understanding, solving such complex real-life applications is not a simple task to design smarter and faster algorithms. I



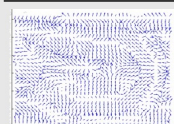
believe that alternative theoretical framework could be designed to optimize the solution to these problems. Below are two significant machine learning and image segmentation problem explaining the necessity of further research in the field.

In classification problems, Adaboost with trees is called the “best off-the-shelf classifier in the world”. However, the exponential loss function for Adaboost incurs substantial misclassification error rate as the penalty increases exponentially for large increasing negative margin. However, the presence of even moderate amount of outlier can mar our proposed method. So, a natural question arises: is there any alternative to Adaboost that can accommodate a computationally efficient, outlier-resilient algorithm for large scale complex classification problems?

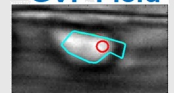
On the image segmentation, nowadays, it is a consensus among majority of image/vision experts that automated segmentation of natural images is an extremely difficult problem. Not surprisingly, so far, the success of segmentation has been demonstrated in application specific imageries, where a priori knowledge about object(s) is available. Markov random field (MRF) provides a rather limited means to incorporate a priori object information. Few recent object models aggrandizes some limitations of MRF-type limited object models by composing an object by its constituent parts in a prescribed spatial order. However, reasonably fast computations are yet to catch up with these theoretical frameworks in large complex segmentation problems. I would like to investigate these issues of computations vis-a-vis the theoretical frameworks in the long run.

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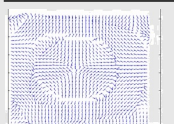
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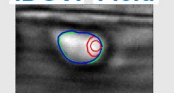
GVF Field



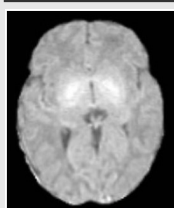
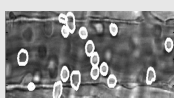
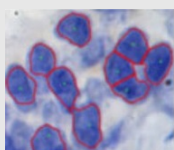
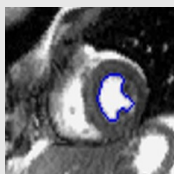
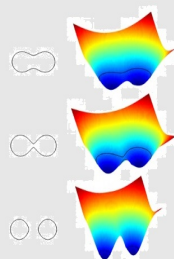
GVF Results



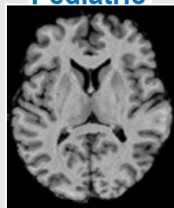
IDGVF Field



IDGVF Results



Pediatric



Adult

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